

Emily Stern

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analyst with three years of combined analytics, applied research, and direct service experience supporting low-income families and economically vulnerable households. Two promotions in two years at the Child Poverty Action Lab. Strong in SQL, Databricks, statistical modeling, and quasi-experimental design. Uniquely positioned to provide insight into how real users decide and save.

ANALYTICS EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst — Child Poverty Action Lab (CPAL)

Dallas, TX · May 2024 – Present

- Redesigned a financial analytics system modeling revenue variation across service type, delivery channel, and payer mix, improving visibility across approximately \$1.08M annually in managed cash flows and supporting operational and strategic decision-making for finance teams.
- Built and maintained stakeholder-facing dashboards and analytical applications across six program areas, integrating multi-source datasets into real-time decision tools that reduced manual reporting overhead by 8–10 hours per week and improved cross-functional access to actionable insights.
- Designed a probabilistic record linkage and evaluation pipeline analyzing how housing instability relates to long-term student outcomes, applying matched-sampling methods and ordinal logistic regression to support intervention-focused decision-making.
- Developed scalable Databricks data pipelines with API integrations, schema design, and historical change tracking, creating clean and reliable datasets for downstream analytics, reporting, and operational use cases.
- Designed KPI-driven dashboards and analytical frameworks to monitor program performance, surface emerging trends, and support data-informed prioritization for public-sector partners.
- Developed predictive spatial risk models identifying environmental patterns associated with violent crime risk and partnered with operational stakeholders to translate analytical findings into targeted intervention strategies and resource allocation decisions.

DIRECT SERVICE & APPLIED RESEARCH

Three years of hands-on work with low-income families, working parents, immigrant households with young children, and individuals navigating financial and housing instability.

Impact Data Assistant — Girls Inc. of Metropolitan Dallas

Part-time · Dallas, TX · Jan 2024 – Aug 2024

- Analyzed program performance against logic-model outcomes for youth development programs serving underserved communities; established Compass 365 data collection protocols that improved reporting consistency across multiple program sites.

Culturally Responsive Research in Developmental Science Fellow

National Science Foundation · Richardson, TX · Aug 2023 – Aug 2024

- Selected for competitive national fellowship in developmental science; applied research design and systematic literature review to community-based research with a focus on culturally responsive methods.

“Juega Conmigo” Program Facilitator

UT Dallas Center for Children and Families · Aug 2023 – May 2024

- Co-facilitated a bilingual playful-learning program for children 0–3 and their families, coaching parents on research-based strategies to support optimal child development.

Crisis Advocate — Hope’s Door New Beginning Center

Full-time · Plano, TX · Jan 2023 – Dec 2023

- Served survivors of domestic violence and their families in emergency shelters; operated a 24-hour crisis hotline, conducted case management, and connected survivors to local resources as they navigated rebuilding financial and household stability.

SKILLS

Programming & Data — SQL, R, Python, Databricks (Spark), API integration, ETL/pipeline development, schema design.

Analytics & Experimentation — Quasi-experimental design, matched sampling, causal inference, GLMs, panel/longitudinal analysis, cohort and retention analysis, statistical diagnostics, feature engineering, clustering, PCA.

Visualization — Shiny, ggplot2, Plotly, Highcharter, Mapbox, Maplibre. Currently building proficiency in Tableau and Amplitude.

Decision Support — Stakeholder-facing analytical applications, KPI dashboarding, decision systems, behavioral analysis, program evaluation, spatial analysis, survey research.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Dallas — May 2026

M.S. Social Data Analytics and Research · Graduate Certificate in Program Evaluation

University of Texas at Dallas — August 2024

B.S. Psychology